

ALLIANCE HIGH SCHOOL

CHAIRMAN OF THE BOARD
DONALD KANIARU LLB (Hons.) Dar
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To the Admissions Committee,

RE: COUNSELOR RECOMMENDATION FOR MARTIN THIGA WAKABA

I write this recommendation to support Martin Wakaba's application for admission into your undergraduate program. I was Martin's school counselor and served as patron of the St John's Ambulance Club thus interacted with him frequently during his time at Alliance High School.

I organized Martin's exchange program to Denmark in December 2016 and had a first-hand opportunity to know his personality. The aim of the trip was to expose the students to an entirely different learning environment. He approached me while he was in Form Two inquiring about the program that was normally attended by Form Threes. I allowed him to take part in the vigorous vetting process that the students go through in an attempt to be part of the team the school chooses to represent it in Europe. The process included an interview as well as a speech to the entire school seeking its support and nomination. He passed the interview stage and remained with an address to the school. The beginning of his speech was marred by jeers from the senior students as they felt that he was vying for a slot that came naturally to them. But as he continued with his speech, the jeers subsided and the school, and both teachers and students was impressed by his ability to properly convey and articulate his thoughts. At the end of his address, he had garnered enough backing from the school to be the first form two student to qualify for the trip. In doing so, he inspired more junior students to seek and qualify for annual exchange programs, which saw a rise in the students seeking to broaden their exposure of the outside world.

Martin showcased the qualities of a leader seeking to undo the depreciative status quo and better those around him. As the head of the major first aid team in the school, he noted how ill-equipped the students would be if unforeseen disasters occurred on the school campus. He approached the school's administration and suggested the need for public training of the students on how to reduce the effects of disasters such as a fire breakout. The school contacted St John's Ambulance headquarters in Nairobi requesting them to train the students on ways to minimize the impact that a fire would have on the school. This resulted into a successful fire drill and first aid training of the entire school, a remarkable step towards ensuring the safety of his fellow students. He also led joint club projects such as organizing blood donations from the students to the nearby hospitals. It was through his leadership that such exercises always came out as complete successes. In competitions, he led the club to qualify for the national level, a feat that had not been achieved in the recent past after subsequent years of unsatisfactory performance.

Martin stands out as one of the best students that the school has been able to produce. I am proud to have had an impact on his growth process. He has come out of the school as a complete student and it is my firm belief that he will continue to be so in your institution.

Yours faithfully,

Patrick Esendi

Counselor and Patron of the St John's Ambulance Club.



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Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION LETTER FOR MARTIN THIGA WAKABA

I interacted with Martin in all the years he was in Alliance High School. In his first year, I was his Swahili teacher and doubled up as his Dorm Master. Moreover, his second year, as the classes were split, I also became his class teacher and had the opportunity not just to know him at the dorm level, but also within the classroom walls.

Swahili was his lowest performing subject in his time at the school but he recognized this and took it upon himself to seek ways to improve his situation. He would approach me seeking reference for resource material to improve his performance. He would ensure that he had handed in his assignments on time and was ever attentive in class. Martin participated regularly in class especially during the analysis of the set books during literature lessons. It was clear that he had not only gone through the books before class but had internalized the styles needed to fully grasp its content. He never grew tired of exerting himself in order to improve his grades and it was this resilience that enabled him to surpass all expectations on how he would perform in the subject during his final examinations. He achieved an A- in the subject, and was among the best performers across the stream.

Martin was a devoted and patriotic member of the Sellwood house and played a part in its success even as his time at the school drew to an end. He often participated in house activities on which all the thirteen houses in the school are ranked. One example is Farm work, which was primarily tending to a small piece of land allocated by the school as an effort to promote environmental conservation within the school. He also participated in the inter-house mathematics competitions, inter-house tennis, and inter-house soccer. He also led the dance and choreography team in the inter-house music elocutions which are an annual event at the end of the first term. The team was always in the top three houses for two consecutive years, a feat last achieved in 2011.

In spite of his involvement in various extracurricular activities, he was able to display exceptional academic performances term after term. He was often among the top 20 students in the stream academically. I attribute his performance to his hard work, determination, and focus. His high level of organization enabled him to balance his academic life and his extracurricular activities.

I am confident that based on his performance in secondary school, both in and out of the classroom, he will continue to apply himself to the best of his ability. He brings an energetic and passionate thrust into all that he does and thus he would be of great value to your school.

Yours sincerely,

Davis Malesi,

Class teacher. Dorm master and Swahili teacher.



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To the Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR MARTIN THIGA WAKABA

I interacted with Martin as his Physics teacher and as the school's chaplain. From the first instances I interacted with him, I noted his enthusiasm for Physics and as I got to know him this was confirmed by his performance and how eager he was to contribute to the lessons.

In the class, he differentiated himself by his wide grasp of topics both in and out of the syllabus. This was brought forward by the discussions that he initiated in class and his critical analysis and challenge of the concepts that I taught. He was the best performing student in my class and usually among the top if not the top across the stream. He was the assistant Physics coordinator and sometimes I would task him with guiding his peers with exam revision as well as tackling challenging revision questions. He acted as the bridge between me and the students on matters that the students felt that they could not approach me directly. In one situation, majority of the class had been performing below my expectation and he approached me, on behalf of the students, to seek ways of improving the class mean. I sat down with him to discuss the challenges the students were facing in class and it occurred to me that they found it difficult to cope with my pace of teaching and they were not exposing themselves to practice tests prior to the exams. We agreed that each party would play its part, I teaching at a slower pace and the students would do practice exams twice a month. The result was a drastic improvement in the performance of the class in Physics and it continued achieving a higher mean up to and including the final exam.

By his last year of high school, I had long since known of his passion for the subject and his will to push himself further in pursuit of more knowledge and new obstacles. It was in this line that I nominated him to represent the school in the National Mathematics and Sciences competition in the Physics category. The competition was held at Loreto Limuru Girls High School in March. He was selected to join the team and was unanimously appointed as its leader. I was sure that they would deliver and this was confirmed as the team became third nationally, and in the process edging out rival schools and bringing pride to the school.

My interaction with Martin showed me that he demonstrated a capacity to thrive in an all-inclusive educational environment. He proved that he is an all-rounded student, leader and teammate in and out of the classroom. I believe that he will continue to show dedication and passion in everything he does. It is with this experience that I strongly recommend him for your school.

Yours faithfully,

Reverend Dishon Ndubai,
Physics teacher and Chaplain Alliance High School.



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RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR MARTIN THIGA WAKABA

I came to know Martin while he was in Form Two. In my years as Martin's mathematics teacher, he was never shy to provide the answers to questions which he knew or to approach the board to solve questions that the class found difficult to solve. It was this boldness and leadership that prompted me to appoint him as the Mathematics representative of the class in his second year. I was not surprised when he rose to become the Mathematics representative of the entire stream in his fourth year. His leadership skills and effort in class, through my guidance, enabled the class to have the highest mean in Mathematics across the streams in the final high school exams.

Martin displayed commitment and diligence in all that he did. This was evident in the class group projects that he was tasked with completing. He always strived to perfect them and often ended up doing so. Amongst his peers, he stood out as an approachable individual who was ready to help anyone in any way he could. I noted the remarkable impact he had on his desk mate whose performance improved gradually over the last two years. Malcolm managed to progress from averaging a C+ to achieving A minuses. In one exam he even edged out Martin by a mark and at the end of his final examination he, alongside Martin, had an A in mathematics. This was not just Malcolm's story as under his leadership most of the class members improved in performance. He set up a competitive spirit in class by initiating internal mathematics competitions between the class rows. This resulted in an attitude change towards the subject and was a tremendous contribution to the strides that the majority of the students made over the course of their time in class.

Due to his sterling grades and his contribution to the class, I regularly nominated him to represent the class in the internal school mathematics contests. He was usually among the top performers in the competition and this earned him a permanent slot on the school's math team. He attended various mathematics symposiums and his name rarely missed from the list of students awarded after each competition. It was his high level of skill and accuracy that prompted the school to nominate him to take part in the International Mathematics Olympiad which he reached the second round.

Martin's performance was not only exemplary in Mathematics but also in other subjects that he took. He was often recognized for his academic performance during the last assembly of the term where the Deputy Principal would call out the names of the top students in each form. He was also named while listing the best performers per subject, especially in Mathematics and Physics. I attribute this to his tendency to ensure perfection in everything he undertook and the zeal he showed while pursuing his studies at the school.

Martin was the best student in my class in terms of performance and his association with other classmates and teachers. He is a valuable asset to the community in which he resides and therefore I write this recommendation with the utmost belief that his contribution to your school will be of great value.

Yours sincerely,

Catherine Ndigirigi,

Mathematics teacher 4Q Class of 2018.



Dear Admissions Committee,

RE: RECOMMENDATION FOR MARTIN THIGA WAKABA, PF 33573

Martin is a scholar in the Equity Leadership Program under Equity Bank Limited. Every year the ELP absorbs the best performers in the country as per their Kenya Certificate of Secondary Education examinations performance, and through an intensive internship and mentorship, installs in them requisite skills for their career success. For the first eight months of this year, he worked under my supervision as an intern at the Equity Bank Thika Plaza branch.

Martin joined the branch at the end of January. He was a neat young man whose friendly and warm nature quickly made him a favorite amongst the other staff. I assigned him to the Equitel desk where he was tasked with customer registration and addressing complaints. He quickly found his footing at the desk and his high work rate heavily reduced the workload of his supervisor. Through cooperation and teamwork with university students interning at the desk, our branch was consistently among the top five branches in the country in the issue and replacement of Equitel SIM cards.

Furthermore, he was an avid and flexible learner, making him a key asset at the branch. In February, one of our staff transferred creating a vacancy that left us highly disadvantaged. This because the bank was expected to issue ATM cards of the Inua Jamii program in the next month. Therefore, I assigned Martin to the Accounts Opening desk to serve as the PIN Officer. He nonetheless worked with the general ease of a more experienced member of staff, despite being new to the task. His charisma and care when dealing with the customers made sure that they left the bank satisfied. His speed and accuracy were such that the customers barely queued before being served and thus continued the level of our branch's quality in customer service.

Martin disposition was firmly rooted in the corporate philosophies governing the bank. He showed professionalism and integrity when issuing premium ATM cards to the branch's most prestigious clients. The bar was set even higher when he was further tasked with in-house cheque clearing and addressing custodial issues alongside the buying and selling of shares. He managed to perform all these duties proficiently without failing in either one.

Martin possessed a teamwork spirit that was evident in his relations with his workmates. He was always willing to step in for members of staff who were unable to make it to the branch without neglecting his duties.

Martin was also proactive in his duties to the physical branch itself. He comprehensively did his weekly and monthly snap checks with diligence. They would range from infrastructural to procedural checks such as door maintenance to account opening procedures, as well as how to address or improve them. The result was an improvement in the aesthetic status of the bank and the quality of our customers' experience.

Martin stands out among the various interns I have had a chance to work with. He left an impressive impact, and I thank him for his service. He displayed vigor and commitment as he worked with the bank under my guidance and I do not doubt that he will do the same at your school.

Yours faithfully,



Ronah Muthoni,

Operations Manager.

Equity Bank, Thika Plaza Branch.